PARRAMATTA POSSIBILITIES

Public Challenge Briefing Notes

Generated using Microsoft Co-Pilot, reviewed and updated by Council Officers

Five challenge briefs for the Build with AI Innovation Challenge

Purpose: To provide participants with clear problem boundaries, public data links, Council service and strategy alignment, responsible AI constraints, and examples of creative responses that do not depend on privileged Council information.

Prepared for public challenge use | 6 November 2026

Public information only. Internal operational data, personal information, confidential records, security details, and unpublished asset data are excluded.

Common participant guidance

Public-facing note: Participants are encouraged to use open, publicly available and non-personal data when developing their solutions. The resources provided are starting points only. Teams may identify and combine additional reputable open datasets. Solutions should follow responsible AI principles, including privacy, security, fairness, transparency, human oversight and appropriate use of data. Any prototype should clearly distinguish evidence, assumptions and generated content.

Council boundary and the role of advocacy

Council can lead, facilitate, regulate, plan, deliver local services, form partnerships and provide evidence. However, it cannot directly solve every issue that depends on State or Commonwealth powers, private infrastructure, market behaviour or industry investment. Under the NSW Local Government Act, the governing body must act consistently with Council plans and policies, allocate resources for the local area, review service delivery, consult stakeholders and act honestly, efficiently and appropriately. Council functions may also be exercised jointly with other councils or partners.

NSW Local Government Act 1993, section 223 | section 355 | Office of Local Government guidance

Stretch outcome: Where Council does not control the full solution, a strong prototype can still create credible evidence for advocacy to the NSW Government, Australian Government, regulators, utilities, telecommunications providers, transport operators, universities or industry. A useful advocacy output identifies the problem, affected communities, evidence gap, proposed partner, requested action and measurable public benefit.

Governance constraints translated into challenge rules

- Use public, licensed, participant-generated or clearly labelled dummy data only. Do not scrape restricted systems or infer personal information.
- Dummy or synthetic data is acceptable for prototyping when it is reasonable, representative enough to test the concept, and the team shows that equivalent real data could be acquired lawfully and cost-effectively for a pilot. State how the dummy data was created, which assumptions it contains, what real source would replace it, the expected acquisition method and indicative cost or effort.
- Collect the minimum data needed. Avoid names, faces, number plates, precise household locations, sensitive attributes and individual behavioural profiles.
- Use approved, secure environments. Do not upload Council or participant-sensitive information into unapproved AI services.
- AI may support analysis, drafting and prototyping, but it must not make consequential decisions autonomously. A human remains accountable.
- Document sources, transformations, limitations and assumptions. Make it possible for another person to reproduce or challenge the result.
- Test for bias, misleading outputs and uneven impacts across languages, ages, abilities, suburbs and levels of digital access.
- Design for containment and correction: if data is wrong or a model behaves badly, the prototype should allow removal, correction, suspension and review.

These boundaries reflect Council's current Cyber and Information Security Policy, Data Governance Framework, Data Breach Policy and Interim AI Governance Policy. The policies emphasise confidentiality, integrity and availability; access control and secure handling; privacy and regulatory compliance; data quality and stewardship; human oversight; approved AI tools; disclosure; and the rule that poor or outdated source data and vague prompts produce unreliable outputs.

Why clean, explainable and credible data matters

AI can amplify both signal and error. Duplicate records, inconsistent dates, missing values, ambiguous location names, stale information or biased samples can produce confident but incorrect recommendations. “Clean” data means more than tidy columns. It means clear definitions, known provenance, appropriate licensing, consistent units and geography, documented quality checks, current timestamps, and an honest statement of what the dataset does not represent.

- Credibility test: Can a reviewer identify the original source, date, coverage, method and licence?
- Explainability test: Can the team show how raw observations became a score, map, classification or recommendation?
- Fitness test: Is the data suitable for this decision, geographic scale and population, rather than merely available?
- Human test: Has local experience or user research been used to check what the data misses?

Data is not everything: The most valuable idea may combine a small amount of trustworthy evidence with service design, behavioural insight, storytelling, policy change or a new partnership. Creative thinking is the ability to reframe the problem, not simply adding a larger model or more datasets.

Hackathon guidance

Build something that can be demonstrated. A strong entry should include one defined user, one clearly stated problem, one working interaction, a public, licensed, participant-created or clearly labelled dummy dataset, a clear explanation of what AI does, a human decision point, one user test, one measurable community benefit and a realistic next step.

Dummy data is welcome when practical: Teams may use dummy or synthetic data if it is plausible and sufficient to test the concept. The submission must explain how comparable real data could be obtained lawfully, ethically and at reasonable cost for a pilot. Include the likely source, collection method, frequency, permissions, indicative cost or staff effort, and any quality or representativeness risks. Dummy data must never be presented as observed Council data.

Acceptable prototype forms

- Clickable interface or service journey
- Lightweight web or mobile application
- Power Apps or other no-code/low-code prototype
- Power BI evidence dashboard linked to a defined decision workflow
- Map-based proof of concept or digital-twin storyboard
- Retrieval assistant using approved public documents
- Rules-based triage or AI-assisted communication tool with human approval
- Computer-vision demonstration using open, participant-created or dummy data
- A slide deck alone is not a working prototype, the core interaction must be demonstrable.

What teams should be ready to show

- Problem: who has the problem and what happens today
- Prototype: the working interaction
- Evidence: the public, licensed, participant-created or dummy data used
- Responsible AI: what AI does, what can go wrong and who remains accountable
- Community benefit: what changes if the idea works
- Feasibility: what a small pilot would require, including real-data acquisition
- Path forward: Council delivery, partnership, advocacy, community action or a market solution

Participation does not represent Council procurement, funding, endorsement or a commitment to implement a solution.

Public links by challenge

Challenge	Public source	How it can be used
1 Climate	Bureau of Meteorology: Parramatta North climate statistics	Temperature, rainfall, humidity and long-term climate baselines.
1 Climate	Western Sydney University: Benchmarking Heat in Parramatta	Local research and linked urban-heat dataset.
1 Climate	Environmental Sustainability Strategy	Council priorities for resilience, regeneration and climate action.
2 Events	Council plans and strategies	Major Events, inclusion, culture, economy and place strategies.
2 Events	Transport for NSW Open Data Hub	Public transport, geospatial, real-time and API resources.
2 Events	Major Events and Festivals Strategy	Strategic approach to inclusive, sustainable events and visitation.
3 Clean neighbourhoods	Data.gov.au: Parramatta datasets	Open flood, stormwater, catchment and other public government datasets.
3 Clean neighbourhoods	NSW EPA data and reports	Waste, recycling and resource-recovery evidence.
4 Growing city	Parramatta Development Control Plan 2023	Planning, built form, environmental management and transport controls.
4 Growing city	City development plans and strategies	LEP, LSPS, precinct planning and community infrastructure.
4 Growing city	Australian Bureau of Statistics Census	Population, housing, work, travel and community characteristics.
5 Assets & environment	Data.gov.au: Parramatta datasets Data Visualisation Hub | City of Parramatta	Public stormwater, floodplain and catchment context.
5 Assets & environment	Australian Government secure-by-design guidance	Security principles for digital prototypes and connected systems.
All challenges	WSTI Festi 2026	Challenge timeline, participation options and pitch process.

Participants should check the terms, licence, update date and geographic coverage for each source before use.

Challenge 1: Climate resilience and community wellbeing

Challenge 1 should allow teams to select one of these defined Council questions. PS-01 also connects to Challenge 4 where a digital twin is used to explain a specific growth or resilience decision.

Council problem statements addressed

ID	Problem statement to Council services to the community
PS-01	How might we use a digital twin to help understand the impacts of climate change, future growth, resource use such as water, energy and waste, urban heat island, green cover and community resilience?
PS-02	How might we translate state-wide NARCliM data to reflect microclimate conditions across the LGA?
PS-03	How might we collect and analyse community or citizen science data to understand micro or local impacts of climate change and potential adaptation measures?

Challenge question: How might council develop its planning, monitoring, facilities and communications services to help a person travelling through Parramatta during extreme heat or storms/floods using public, current and explainable information?

Scope and boundary

Teams could select one user group, one place or service context, and one testable outcome. The goal is not to solve the entire policy area or build a production Council system during the challenge. The prototype should demonstrate a credible pathway from evidence to action while respecting Council's statutory, financial, privacy, cyber and governance obligations.

Build card

Primary user: A person travelling through Parramatta during extreme heat, storms or floods, and how to communicate to different groups such as an older resident, outdoor worker, parent with a young child or visitor.

Minimum viable prototype

- Choose one user group and one journey or local area.
- Combine at least two public or clearly labelled dummy sources.
- Explain why a route, location or action is safer and show data age and limitations.
- Include human-approved communication and test the prototype with at least two people.

Do not build

- A standalone generic heat map
- Medical diagnosis or personalised health advice
- Automatic emergency warnings presented as official Council advice

Suggested success measures: A user can identify a safer route, cooling location or practical action in under two minutes and understand the source and currency of the information, or Council can utilize data and AI to assess the effectiveness of place making design, build and use of resilient sustainable cost effective solutions (or investments) such as use green infrastructure, blue infrastructure, tree canopy etc.

Council services touched

- Environmental sustainability and climate adaptation
- Parks, urban forest and open space
- Libraries, community facilities and community development

- Emergency and resilience planning
- Strategic planning, development controls and public health
- Communications, digital inclusion and community engagement

Potential community benefits

- Reduced exposure to heat and environmental risk
- More equitable access to cooling, shade and trusted information
- Stronger household and neighbourhood preparedness
- Better targeting of investment and advocacy
- Improved environmental literacy and community participation

Strategy and plan alignment

- Community Strategic Plan 2025–2050: “We nurture our environment”, “We put people first” and “We are future focused”
- Environmental Sustainability Strategy 2024–2033: climate action, urban resilience and regeneration
- Smart City & Innovation Strategy 2024–2033: climate adaptation and circular economy; data-led decisions; healthy and inclusive communities
- Parramatta 2050: river-city leadership, collaboration and advocacy

Build on this, do not duplicate it

- Council has completed urban heat research and reviewed heat-mitigation options at high pedestrian-traffic locations. Do not simply produce another generic heat map.
- Council already uses public climate information and has explored AURIN, Landsat, tree-canopy and local heat datasets. A new proposal should add a decision, user experience or action pathway.
- Council has existing emergency, environmental and community communication channels. Avoid proposing a standalone warning app without demonstrating integration, ownership, and ongoing maintenance.
- Climate models may be available from university websites, CSIRO and GitHub that could be applied or developed with code.

Creative directions

- A “cool route” planner that combines shade, drinking water, libraries, transport and time of day, then tests the route with older people or outdoor workers.
- A multilingual heatwave communication kit that converts trusted forecasts into suburb-specific actions and accessible formats, with human approval before publication.
- A community shade audit using simple observations and photos without faces, producing evidence for future capital works or State funding.
- A prototype that compares the cost and benefit of extending library or community-facility hours during extreme heat.

Public starting points

- BOM Parramatta North
- WSU heat research
- Environmental Sustainability Strategy

Suggested evidence standard

State the source and date of every dataset; define the unit of analysis and geographic coverage; describe cleaning and transformations; identify missing or biased groups; show at least one human validation step; disclose AI use; and separate observed facts from assumptions or generated suggestions.

A strong submission will show a clear public problem, an affected user, a feasible prototype, responsible data use, a human accountability point, a measurable benefit and a realistic pathway for Council delivery, partnership or advocacy.

Challenge 2: Better community events and public spaces

Challenge 2 must explicitly address one or more of PS-04 to PS-09. The three priority questions are PS-07 attendance and resources, PS-08 accessible and inclusive planning, and PS-09 operational risk and mitigation.

Council problem statements addressed

ID	Problem statement
PS-04	How might we help event organisers identify missing information and relevant requirements during the early planning stage?
PS-05	How might we estimate waste, cleaning and other operational requirements for events based on factors such as attendance, duration, location and catering?
PS-06	How might we help event teams measure and improve the sustainability, accessibility and community outcomes of events?
PS-07	How might we predict event attendance and resource requirements based on event type, location, seasonality and historical trends?
PS-08	How might we assist event organisers to develop more accessible and inclusive event plans tailored to different audiences?
PS-09	How might we identify potential operational risks and mitigation measures during the planning phase of an event?

Challenge question: How might we help a person with a specific access need confidently plan and participate in a Parramatta event before leaving home or better plan and optimize an event?

Scope and boundary

Teams should select one user group, one place or service context, and one testable outcome. The goal is not to solve the entire policy area or build a production Council system during the challenge. The prototype should demonstrate a credible pathway from evidence to action while respecting Council's statutory, financial, privacy, cyber and governance obligations.

Explicit requirements for Challenge 2

- A Challenge 2 prototype should address at least one identified problem statement and explain any links to the others. Strong concepts may combine attendance estimation, operational planning, inclusion, sustainability and risk controls in one early-planning workflow.
- Where historical Council data is not public, teams may use clearly labelled dummy or synthetic records. The records should be plausible and the team must describe how equivalent real data could be acquired lawfully and cost-effectively for a pilot, including likely source, permissions, collection method, frequency and indicative effort or cost.
- For PS-07, show which attendance and resource variables are used, such as event type, location, capacity, season, day and time, weather, transport, duration, catering and comparable historical events. Present a range or scenario, not a false point prediction.
- For PS-08, identify the intended audiences and test the plan against mobility, sensory, cognitive, language, cultural, family and digital-access needs. Clearly distinguish verified venue information from assumptions or items requiring confirmation.
- For PS-09, include a simple risk register showing likelihood, consequence, proposed control, responsible role, trigger for escalation and residual risk. AI may suggest risks but a human event planner must review and approve them.

Build card

Primary user : A person with a defined access need, such as mobility, sensory, language, family or transport-confidence requirements.

Minimum viable prototype

- Use one real public event or clearly labelled hypothetical event.
- Create a before, during and after journey.
- Identify information that is known, missing or requires confirmation.
- Include an organiser readiness checklist and test the journey with a potential user.

Do not build

- Another public event listing
- Unverified claims that a venue is accessible
- Facial recognition, crowd identification or invasive tracking

Suggested success measure: A participant can identify access conditions, journey options and an assistance pathway without searching across multiple unrelated websites.

Council services touched

- Major events and festivals
- Place management and night-time economy
- Arts, culture and heritage
- Transport planning, walking and cycling
- Public domain, parks and cleansing
- Community inclusion, accessibility and visitor services

Potential community benefits

- More people feel welcome and able to participate
- Safer and easier journeys to and from events
- Stronger cultural identity, visitation and local business activity
- Lower waste and environmental impact
- Better use of public space across the LGA, not just the CBD

Strategy and plan alignment

- Major Events and Festivals Strategy 2025–2030
- Social Sustainability Strategy 2024–2033 and Disability Inclusion Action Plan
- City Economy Strategy 2026–2036
- Parramatta Ways Walking Strategy, Bike Plan and public-domain strategies
- Smart City & Innovation Strategy: movement and place; inclusion; digital participation
- Parramatta 2050: culture, creativity, sport, entertainment and world-class gathering

Build on this, do not duplicate it

- Council already delivers major festivals and award-winning events, including large-scale New Year's Eve and Parramatta Lanes. Do not propose "run more events" without addressing a specific gap.
- Council already publishes event information, and transport operators to publish journey data. Avoid duplicating a generic event calendar or trip planner.
- Council has completed or is progressing wayfinding, public-domain, lighting and place-activation work. Focus on an unresolved user journey, accessibility gap, local centre or evidence need.

Creative directions

- An accessible-event readiness checker covering quiet spaces, toilets, gradients, lighting, transport, sensory needs and multilingual information.
- A "before, during and after" visitor journey prototype that helps local businesses create linked offers around an event.
- A reusable kit for measuring whether an event benefits local centers, using short intercept surveys, public transport information and business participation rather than invasive tracking.
- A low-tech plus digital activation, such as community-led story trails with QR content, printable maps and in-person hosts.

Public starting points

- Council plans and strategies
- Transport Open Data Hub
- City Economy Strategy

Suggested evidence standard

State the source and date of every dataset; define the unit of analysis and geographic coverage; describe cleaning and transformations; identify missing or biased groups; show at least one human validation step; disclose AI use; and separate observed facts from assumptions or generated suggestions.

A strong submission will show a clear public problem, an affected user, a feasible prototype, responsible data use, a human accountability point, a measurable benefit and a realistic pathway for Council delivery, partnership or advocacy.

Challenge 3: Cleaner and more sustainable neighbourhoods

Challenge 3 should allow teams to focus on illegal dumping triage or contamination and behaviour change. Any imagery or household-level information must be public, participant-created, synthetic or clearly labelled dummy data unless separately approved for release.

Council problem statements addressed

ID	Problem statement
PS-10	How might Council more easily and efficiently identify illegal dumping, differentiate it from booked bulky-waste clean-ups, and estimate the size and type of waste in the piles?
PS-11	How might we identify contamination and the capture of FOGO and recycling materials placed in the incorrect or correct bins to better target education and support behaviour change for residents?

Challenge question: How might we help a household, event organiser or local business prevent one common waste stream before it becomes litter, contamination or landfill?

Scope and boundary

Teams should select one user group, one place or service context, and one testable outcome. The goal is not to solve the entire policy area or build a production Council system during the challenge. The prototype should demonstrate a credible pathway from evidence to action while respecting Council's statutory, financial, privacy, cyber and governance obligations.

Build card

Primary user: A household, event organiser or local business dealing with one defined material or waste behaviour.

Minimum viable prototype

- Select one material or behaviour and map its current disposal journey.
- Identify an intervention before waste is created.
- Use reputable public guidance or clearly labelled dummy data.
- Include an action beyond information and define one behavioural measure.

Do not build

- Recreating Council's existing reporting process
- Property-level profiling
- Treating an image-recognition result as proof of compliance

Suggested success measure: The selected user can avoid, reuse, repair or correctly direct one material, with a measurable reduction in disposal or contamination.

Council services touched

- Waste collection and resource recovery
- Street cleansing and illegal-dumping response
- Community education and regulatory services
- Parks, waterways and stormwater
- Procurement and circular economy
- Customer service and neighbourhood engagement

Potential community benefits

- Cleaner streets, parks and waterways
- Lower contamination and disposal costs
- More reuse, repair and recycling
- Targeted education that is fair and evidence-based
- Reduced litter entering drains and the Parramatta River

Strategy and plan alignment

- Waste and Circular Economy Strategy and Action Plan 2026–2036
- Environmental Sustainability Strategy 2024–2033
- Smart City & Innovation Strategy: circular economy, data-led services and innovation
- Community Strategic Plan: environmental regeneration, health and belonging
- Parramatta River and catchment strategies

Build on this, do not duplicate it

- Council already provides standard bin, recycling, clean-up and illegal-dumping services. Do not reproduce the existing request/reporting channel.
- Council is exploring AI-assisted waste analytics and contamination education. You can assume access to collection imagery, household records or property-level operational data.
- Council and regional partners already operate litter, stormwater and waterway programs. A proposal should target a defined gap, behaviour or evidence need.

Creative directions

- A circular “neighbourhood exchange” model connecting repair, swap, charity and material-recovery options, tested in one centre.
- A contamination education prototype based on common publicly documented items, using image recognition only on participant-supplied or open images.
- A litter pathway map combining public drainage/catchment information with community observations to prioritise education or advocate for upstream action.
- A procurement prompt that helps event organisers choose reusable, repairable or recyclable materials before waste is created.

Public starting points

- Data.gov.au Parramatta
- NSW EPA waste data
- Environmental Sustainability Strategy

Suggested evidence standard

State the source and date of every dataset; define the unit of analysis and geographic coverage; describe cleaning and transformations; identify missing or biased groups; show at least one human validation step; disclose AI use; and separate observed facts from assumptions or generated suggestions.

A strong submission will show a clear public problem, an affected user, a feasible prototype, responsible data use, a human accountability point, a measurable benefit and a realistic pathway for Council delivery, partnership or advocacy.

Challenge 4: Smarter decisions for a growing city

Related Council question

PS-01 is also relevant to this challenge where a digital twin is used to understand a defined trade-off involving future growth, climate impacts, resource use, urban heat, green cover, or community resilience. Teams should limit the demonstration to one precinct, one decision and a small number of explainable data layers.

Challenge question: How might we help a community member or decision-maker understand one growth trade-off in one Parramatta location that meets a variety of community needs (weightings/sliders could be used) with consideration for our plans to deliver 2050 strategic goals, with analysis of consequences and residual impact as a decision-making data model using public evidence and clearly stated assumptions?

Scope and boundary

Teams should select one user group, one place or service context, and one testable outcome. The goal is not to solve the entire policy area or build a production Council system during the challenge. The prototype should demonstrate a credible pathway from evidence to action while respecting Council's statutory, financial, privacy, cyber and governance obligations.

Build card

Primary user: A community member or decision-maker considering one growth trade-off in one precinct or local center for this specific master plan > City of Parramatta Council | Draft CBD South Parramatta Precinct Master Plan

Minimum viable prototype

- Focus on one decision and use no more than three to five essential data layers.
- Show at least two scenarios and explain assumptions and uncertainty.
- Include lived-experience input or a structured community observation.
- Distinguish what Council controls, jointly influences or advocates for.

Do not build

- A generic planning dashboard
- A citywide digital twin without a defined decision
- Presenting modelled outputs as predictions

Suggested success measure: A non-technical user can understand the trade-off, evidence, uncertainty and responsible authority within a three-minute demonstration.

Council services touched

- Strategic and land-use planning
- Transport and infrastructure planning
- Community infrastructure, parks and facilities planning
- Economic development and investment
- GIS, data analytics and corporate planning
- Community engagement and advocacy

Potential community benefits

- More transparent and evidence-based choices
- Earlier identification of infrastructure and service needs
- Better coordination across agencies and private providers
- Improved understanding of trade-offs and uncertainty

- Stronger evidence for State and Commonwealth investment

Strategy and plan alignment

- Parramatta 2050 and Community Strategic Plan 2025–2050
- Delivery Program 2025–2029 and Resourcing Strategy
- Local Strategic Planning Statement, LEP and DCP
- City Economy Strategy 2026–2036
- Draft Community Infrastructure Strategy 2026–2046
- Smart City & Innovation Strategy: data-led organisation, innovation ecosystem and movement

Build on this, do not duplicate it

- Council already has statutory planning maps, an LEP, DCP, growth studies and specialist reports. Do not build a generic "planning dashboard" that merely republishes maps.
- Council already uses GIS, dashboards and modelling for several services. A proposal must define the decision, owner, refresh process and action enabled.
- Transport for NSW, ABS and NSW Planning already publish major datasets. Avoid unnecessary duplication and focus on integration, interpretation or an evidence gap.

Creative directions

- A scenario card that shows how one growth assumption changes demand for libraries, parks, transport or cooling, with uncertainty clearly shown.
- A "what Council controls" decision navigator separating local delivery, joint delivery and advocacy responsibilities.
- A digital-twin storyboard rather than a full twin: one precinct, one decision, a small number of well-documented layers and a clear user test.
- A community evidence tool that combines Census data with structured local observations and shows where lived experience differs from aggregate statistics.

Public starting points

- Development plans and strategies
- Parramatta DCP 2023
- ABS Census
- Transport Open Data Hub

Suggested evidence standard

State the source and date of every dataset; define the unit of analysis and geographic coverage; describe cleaning and transformations; identify missing or biased groups; show at least one human validation step; disclose AI use; and separate observed facts from assumptions or generated suggestions.

A strong submission will show a clear public problem, an affected user, a feasible prototype, responsible data use, a human accountability point, a measurable benefit and a realistic pathway for Council delivery, partnership or advocacy.

Challenge 5: AI for smarter environmental asset management

Challenge question: How might we use public, participant-created or dummy data to show a responsible way of flagging environmental monitoring and maintenance issues and ways to optimise and predict, with human verification still required?

Scope and boundary

Teams should select one user group, one place or service context, and one testable outcome. The goal is not to solve the entire policy area or build a production Council system during the challenge. The prototype should demonstrate a credible pathway from evidence to action while respecting Council's statutory, financial, privacy, cyber and governance obligations.

Build card

Primary user: A Council or partner officer who needs to select a new AI enabled flood modelling, monitoring and alerting system for river flooding, or AI solution to inspect images on the state of Gross Pollutant Traps for maintenance, while retaining human verification.

Minimum viable prototype

- Use public, licensed, participant-created, synthetic or clearly labelled dummy data.
- Define the classification or triage task and separate training and test examples.
- Show false positives, false negatives and confidence or uncertainty.
- Route results to a human reviewer and explain correction or removal.

Do not build

- Claims of production accuracy from a small demonstration dataset
- Automatic work orders or regulatory actions
- Faces, number plates or unnecessary personal information
- A new sensor network without a decision, owner, maintenance plan and retention rule

Suggested success measure: The prototype shows whether the approach is promising enough for a controlled pilot rather than claiming operational readiness.

Council services touched

- Asset management and building maintenance
- Stormwater, waterways and environmental monitoring
- Parks, sportsgrounds and public-domain operations
- Waste, cleansing and gross pollutant management
- ICT, cyber security and data governance
- Procurement, risk, records and service planning

Potential community benefits

- Earlier identification of maintenance or environmental risks
- More proactive and cost-effective inspections
- Safer, more reliable community assets
- Better prioritisation using transparent evidence
- Improved environmental outcomes without unnecessary surveillance

Strategy and plan alignment

- Smart City & Innovation Strategy: smart infrastructure, data-led organisation and climate adaptation
- Environmental Sustainability Strategy 2024–2033

- Asset Management Strategy and Resourcing Strategy
- Waste and Circular Economy Strategy 2026–2036
- Interim AI Governance Policy and Data Governance Framework
- Community Strategic Plan: people-first, resilient and future-focused services

Build on this, do not duplicate it

- Council already operates operational systems, sensors and dashboards in selected areas, and has completed a sensor review. Only propose a new sensor network after creating a data model of existing, shared or open data.
- Council has explored water-quality, FloodSmart, smart parking, environmental and waste analytics. Assume internal feeds or access to operational imagery for GPT traps and Floodsmart only.
- Council's policy does not permit autonomous consequential decisions. A prototype must keep a human in the loop and provide an audit trail.

Creative directions

- Use open images or a participant-created dataset to demonstrate a debris/fullness classifier, then present the governance and field-validation plan rather than claiming production accuracy.
- Create a maintenance triage concept combining public weather, asset type and inspection rules, with confidence bands and human approval.
- Design a "minimum viable data" checklist that asks whether a new sensor is necessary, who owns it, how long data is retained and what decision it improves.
- Build an advocacy evidence pack showing where a State agency, utility or industry partner could co-fund monitoring or infrastructure.

Public starting points

- Data.gov.au Parramatta
- Secure-by-design guidance
- Council plans and strategies

GPT images are available below


Swift
ENDURO
0014
096°F 35°C
04/02/2025
13:45:00


Swift
ENDURO
LACKEST 010
073°F 22°C
04/11/2026 11:30:00


Swift
ENDURO
LACKEST 009
073°F 22°C
04/11/2026
11:05:03


Swift
ENDURO
LAKEPAR 013
072°F 22°C
04/11/2026
10:45:00


Swift
ENDURO
018
069°F 20°C
12/06/2024
13:00:01


Swift
ENDURO
STURST 022
085°F 29°C
04/11/2026 14:20:00



Suggested evidence standard

State the source and date of every dataset; define the unit of analysis and geographic coverage; describe cleaning and transformations; identify missing or biased groups; show at least one human validation step; disclose AI use; and separate observed facts from assumptions or generated suggestions.

A strong submission will show a clear public problem, an affected user, a feasible prototype, responsible data use, a human accountability point, a measurable benefit and a realistic pathway for Council delivery, partnership or advocacy.

Submission checklist

- One-sentence problem and named user group
- Public-interest outcome and success measure
- Data register covering public, licensed, participant-created and dummy data, with source, licence, date, assumptions and limitations
- Simple data-cleaning and quality log
- Privacy and cyber check: no sensitive or unnecessary personal information
- Responsible AI statement: tool used, purpose, human oversight and known risks
- Working prototype demonstration and test feedback
- Council boundary: deliver, partner, regulate, facilitate or advocate
- Strategy alignment and explanation of how the idea differs from existing Council work
- Proposed Next step: pilot, further research, service-design test, partnership or advocacy brief, including a lawful and cost-effective path to acquire real data where dummy data was used